Ehsan QORBANI CHEGENI, PhD

Scientific Project Coordination | Research & Proposal Management | Stakeholder Reporting | International Organisations

Professional Summary

PhD natural scientist (Geophysics) with an engineering degree and 20+ years of combined experience in **project management**, **interdisciplinary research** and **scientific coordination** in international settings, including 9 years at a United Nations organisation, the Comprehensive Nuclear-Test-Ban Treaty Organization (CTBTO) in Vienna. Coordinated a team of 21 analysts and the daily publication of event bulletins for a 24/7 global monitoring network; drafted scientific and staffing reports for management and Member State audiences. Organised and convened sessions at EGU and the CTBTO Science and Technology (SnT) Conference (347 abstracts handled) and promoted them on LinkedIn and X. Managed construction projects with teams of up to 100 staff, with responsibility for **budgets**, cost control and permits. Author of 12 peer-reviewed publications, 5 as first author. Aims to apply this experience in science, project delivery and communication to IIASA's Energy, Climate and Environment (ECE) Program.

Key Qualifications

- **Project & financial management:** delivered engineering projects from planning to handover, including budget management and cost control (2007–2011), and managed research projects at the University of Vienna. Won a competitive Young Scientist Research Grant (2013).
- **International organisation experience:** 9 years at the CTBTO (UN system), working with international colleagues and Member State stakeholders under institutional rules and reporting standards.
- **Scientific & policy-relevant reporting:** drafted technical and scientific reports for Member State delegations and decision-makers; wrote the section staffing report and the SnT session scientific reports.
- **Events, outreach & communication:** organiser and convener at the EGU General Assembly (2017–2026, 9 sessions, 167 abstracts) and the SnT Conference (2021–2025, 3 sessions, 180 abstracts). Promoted sessions on LinkedIn and X. Gave 40+ talks and posters at international conferences and workshops.
- **Interdisciplinary research & mentoring:** research linking geophysics, large-scale data management and applications; 12 peer-reviewed publications (5 as first author). Co-supervised 2 PhD researchers and mentored 1 MSc student.
- **Collaboration tools:** SharePoint (2-year task force, division-wide document system for approx. 80 staff), MS Teams (daily for 4 years), GitHub, advanced MS Office.

Professional Experience

Data Analyst – Lead Analyst & Team Coordinator Nov 2017 – Oct 2026

Monitoring and Data Analysis (MDA) Section, International Data Centre, CTBTO (United Nations) – Vienna, Austria

- **Coordinated** a team of 21 analysts together with the Section Chief, setting weekly, monthly and long-term targets. As on-call Duty Analyst, handled alert events and special requests and delivered timely information products and graphical reports.
- **Organised** the bulletin submission process and the infrasound analysis team's workload, delivering quality-controlled bulletins from 218 global seismic, hydroacoustic and infrasound stations to Member States on schedule. Identified and resolved analysis issues across the workflow, improving clarity, efficiency and quality.
- **Drafted and managed** MDA scientific and staffing reports for section management, covering workload, coverage and resource planning.
- **Represented** the MDA Section (30 staff) on a 2-year cross-section task force that designed and built a SharePoint document-management system, now used across the entire division (approx. 80 staff). Designed the section's document hierarchy.
- **Acted** as primary point of contact and senior user for testing new monitoring software and stations, turning user feedback into prioritised improvement requests.

- **Organised and convened** 3 sessions at the CTBTO Science and Technology (SnT) Conference (2021–2025), coordinating speakers and abstracts and writing the session scientific reports.
- **Designed and delivered** training for international analysts, including instructor roles at the Global Seismological Observation Training Course (Japan, 2024) and CTBTO waveform-analysis courses (2023–2024).
- **Published** 4 peer-reviewed journal articles alongside operational duties.

Postdoctoral Researcher (2016–2017) | Doctoral Researcher (2011–2016) Nov 2011 – Oct 2017
Department of Meteorology and Geophysics, University of Vienna – Vienna, Austria

- **Managed** two research projects from planning to publication, coordinating co-authors, partner institutions and timelines. Secured a competitive Young Scientist Research Grant (2013).
- **Co-designed** a seismic sensor network across the Eastern Alps for the international EASI project (Eastern Alpine Seismic Investigation), covering site selection and deployment.
- **Published** 8 peer-reviewed papers, 4 of them from the PhD thesis.
- **Taught** graduate courses in the Geophysics MSc programme.
- **Won** the Austrian Geophysical Society (AGS) Award for Best Scientific Work (2015).

Site Engineer / Project Manager / Site Manager 2002–2004, 2007–2011
Kharadezh GmbH (engineering & construction) – Iran

- **Led** road, bridge and tunnel projects as Project Manager and Site Manager (2007–2011), with teams of 20–100 staff and subcontractors, including a 2 km urban tunnel and a 500 m drill-and-blast tunnel. Earlier worked as Site Engineer on a dam project (2002–2004).
- **Managed** project budgets and cost control (2007–2011), and prepared cost, progress and schedule reports (MS Project) for clients, design consultants and authorities, securing the required permits.

Scientific Events, Communication & Service

- **Session organiser and convener**, European Geosciences Union (EGU) General Assembly, Vienna, 2017–2026: proposed and organised 9 sessions, managed the call for abstracts, reviewed and scheduled 167 abstracts, chaired sessions and promoted them on LinkedIn and X.
- **Session organiser, convener and rapporteur**, CTBTO Science and Technology (SnT) Conference, Vienna, 2021–2025: organised 3 sessions, reviewed and scheduled 180 abstracts, coordinated speakers and wrote the session scientific reports.
- **Presentations:** 40+ talks and posters at international conferences and workshops. Best Poster Award, SnT Conference (2017).
- **Supervision:** co-supervised 2 doctoral researchers (1 completed) and mentored 1 master's student.
- **Peer reviewer** for Geophysical Journal International, Tectonophysics, Journal of Geodynamics and Pure and Applied Geophysics (2016–present).

Education

- **PhD, Natural Sciences (Geophysics)**, University of Vienna, Austria 2011–2016
- **MSc, Geophysics**, Institute for Advanced Studies in Basic Sciences (IASBS), Zanjan, Iran 2004–2007
- **BSc, Engineering (Extractive Materials Engineering)**, Isfahan, Iran 1997–2002

Skills

- **Project management:** planning, milestone and deadline tracking, budget management and cost control, progress reporting, MS Project, proposal writing
- **Collaboration, web & social media:** SharePoint (document hierarchy design, document management), MS Teams, GitHub, LinkedIn and X (formerly Twitter) for event promotion and scientific outreach
- **MS Office (advanced):** Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook
- **AI-assisted productivity:** Microsoft Copilot (daily workplace use) and Claude for drafting and editing reports, summarising documents and meeting notes, and streamlining routine tasks, with human review and data-confidentiality safeguards
- **Data & science:** Python, Bash, MATLAB, SQL, GIS (ArcGIS, GMT), Linux, LaTeX

Languages

English (fluent, full professional proficiency) | German (B1) | Persian (native)

Selected Publications & Presentations

Peer-reviewed publications (first author)

- **Qorbani, E.**, Kolínský, P., Bianchi, I., Zigone, D. & Bokelmann, G. (2022). Upper crustal structure at the KTB drilling site from ambient noise tomography. *Geophysical Journal International*, 231(2), 982–995. doi:10.1093/gji/ggac233
- **Qorbani, E.**, Zigone, D., Handy, M. R., Bokelmann, G. & AlpArray-EASI Working Group (2020). Crustal structures beneath the Eastern and Southern Alps from ambient noise tomography. *Solid Earth*, 11, 1947–1968. doi:10.5194/se-11-1947-2020
- **Qorbani, E.**, Bokelmann, G., Kovács, I., Horváth, F. & Falus, G. (2016). Deformation in the asthenospheric mantle beneath the Carpathian-Pannonian region. *Journal of Geophysical Research: Solid Earth*. doi:10.1002/2015JB012604
- **Qorbani, E.**, Kurz, W., Bianchi, I. & Bokelmann, G. (2015). Correlated crustal and mantle deformation in the Tauern Window, Eastern Alps. *Austrian Journal of Earth Sciences*, 108(1), 159–171. doi:10.17738/ajes.2015.0010
- **Qorbani, E.**, Bianchi, I. & Bokelmann, G. (2015). Slab detachment under the Eastern Alps seen by seismic anisotropy. *Earth and Planetary Science Letters*, 409, 96–108. doi:10.1016/j.epsl.2014.10.049

Manuscript in preparation (as PhD co-supervisor)

- Ntibinyane, O., **Qorbani, E.**, Estève, C., Kramer, R. & Bokelmann, G. Improved imaging of the crustal structure of Botswana and its environs from ambient noise tomography. To be submitted to *Geophysical Journal International*.

Selected recent conference contributions (first author)

- **Qorbani, E.**, et al. (2025). Global detection of volcanic activities at the International Data Centre. CTBTO Science and Technology Conference (SnT), Vienna.
- **Qorbani, E.**, et al. (2024). Performance variability of the hydroacoustic and infrasound IMS stations. EGU General Assembly, Vienna, EGU24-20403. doi:10.5194/egusphere-egu24-20403

Full list of 12 peer-reviewed publications: orcid.org/0000-0003-3961-4280